LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 52 · November 09, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 52 is the 'what counts as in hand' daf: a firstborn takes his double portion only from what his father possessed at death — not from post-mortem improvement (sheva■), nor from property merely owed to him (ra'ui). The same bar falls on the widow's ketubah, the daughters' sustenance and the yavam — then the Jubilee, and which holdings return.

בכור נוטל פי שנים · AARON'S FIVE CHILDREN



1. Shemini says God spoke to Aaron 'and his remaining sons.' Aaron started with four sons; two died, two are left. Why 'remaining' — a word used only for a minority?

“Because Aaron didn't have four children — Nadav was a firstborn, so he counts double. Five children, two left: they really are 'the remaining ones.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52a · the firstborn's double portion · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 0:44

מוחזק VS ראוי · POSTHUMOUS ROYALTIES



2. A talmid chacham dies leaving manuscripts, to be printed and sold after his death. The money hasn't come in yet — ra'ui (merely due) or muchzak (in hand)?

“The Beit Yitzchak: ra'ui — the books don't exist yet. But divide the manuscripts themselves, and the firstborn gets his double share of the paper.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52a · no double portion in shevach or in ra'ui · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 3:31

בעל חוב גובה את השבח · THE THIEF DOES BETTER THAN THE BUYER



3. Shmuel: a creditor collects even the improvement a buyer made to a liened field — the buyer improves it, the creditor takes the whole thing. Why should the buyer lose his investment?

“To encourage lending — if lenders had to pay for improvements, nobody would lend. The proof? A thief who improves stolen property must be repaid. We treat the thief better than the buyer.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52a · Shmuel: a creditor collects the enhancement · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 13:18

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ירושת הבעל · HOW RABBEINU TAM GOT HIS NAME



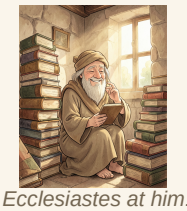
4. A couple marries; within the first year the wife dies. The husband inherits her — including the handsome dowry her father gave her. What did Rabbeinu Tam do?

“His takanah: within the first year, the father gets the money back. And his name? He was really Rabbi Yaakov ben Meir — called 'Tam' from the verse 'ותם לריק כחכם': a man works and works, and loses it all for nothing.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52b · the husband who inherits his wife · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 24:52

טובה חכמה עם נחלה · THE BLIND SAGE'S BEKIA'UT



5. Rav Sheshet objects, and Rav Chama quotes Ecclesiastes at him: 'Wisdom is good with an inheritance — and more so for those who see the sun.' What does that have to do with anything?

“Rav Sheshet was blind. 'Those who see the sun' is the Gemara's euphemism for the blind — so the verse praises him: a man who cannot see, yet amassed enormous bekia'ut.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52b · 'Wisdom is good with an inheritance' (Ecclesiastes 7:11) · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 33:19

פגם משפחה · THE SHUL SEAT AND THE CAVE OF MACHPELAH



6. A shul seat was once a real asset, held by families for generations. If it was sold, can the family demand it back? The Rema says: if there's a real pegam mishpacha, yes.

“And that's how the Meshech Chochma explains why the Torah keeps repeating that Abraham bought Machpelah 'before the eyes of the children of Chet.' Everyone in town was a relative — and Abraham wanted them all to see and accept the sale.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 52b · R. Yochanan ben Beroka: return the family burial plot · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 38:03